

Owner: Owen Pryce, IT & Systems Manager
Approved by: Helen Marsh, Chief Executive
Approved on: 20 January 2026
Next review: January 2027
Applies to: all employees, contractors and temporary staff

1. Purpose

This policy sets the minimum rules for using company systems, devices and data. Breaches may lead to disciplinary action.

2. Accounts and passwords

- Every user has a named account. Shared logins are not allowed, except the warehouse scanner kiosk account, which can only reach the WMS.
- Passwords must be at least 14 characters. Use the company password manager.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is required for email, the finance system, the web shop admin and remote access.
- Never write passwords in documents, spreadsheets, chat messages or notes files.

3. Devices

- Only company laptops may be used to access finance and HR systems.
- Full-disk encryption and automatic screen lock (5 minutes) are required.
- Security updates must be installed within 14 days of release.
- Report lost or stolen devices to IT within 1 hour.

4. Email and phishing

- Treat any request to change supplier bank details as suspicious. Always call the supplier back on the number in our records before changing anything.
- Report suspicious emails with the "Report phishing" button.
- All staff complete phishing awareness training every 6 months.

5. Access control

- Access follows least privilege and is approved by the line manager.
- Leavers' accounts are disabled on their last working day.
- Payroll and HR folders are limited to the People team and the Finance Director.
- IT reviews admin rights every quarter.

6. Data handling

- Files are classified as public, internal, confidential or restricted.
- Restricted data (personal data, salaries, bank and card details, credentials) stays in approved systems and must not be sent to personal email addresses.
- USB storage devices are blocked by default.

7. Backups

- Servers and the shared drive are backed up every night; backups are kept 30 days.
- A test restore is done every quarter and logged.

8. Incidents

- Report security incidents at once to it@kestrelbay.example or 0117 496 0740.
- IT logs every incident and writes an incident report within 2 working days.

9. Remote working

- Use the company VPN on untrusted networks. Do not work on confidential documents in public places where screens can be overlooked.